



BEFORE

Texas and Arkansas both declared for the South and Missouri was the focus of much prewar conflict. Other territories had divided loyalties.

THE INDIAN TERRITORY

The Indian Territory (modern-day Oklahoma), was occupied primarily by **eastern American Indian tribes** that had been **forcibly relocated** there in the 1830s. When the war broke out, most of these tribes **sided with the Confederacy** in the belief that Southern independence represented their **best chance for greater autonomy**.

THE BATTLE OF PEA RIDGE



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On March 7, 1862 a Union army routed a numerically superior Confederate force at Pea Ridge, the battle in northern Arkansas often termed **the Gettysburg of the West**.

The Trans-Mississippi area—Texas, Arkansas, the Indian Territory, Missouri, and Kansas—did not see as much conventional fighting as the Western and Eastern Theaters. But military events in this region affected Northern and Southern morale, and thus the political arena. Confederate domination of this region would spell